



TMJ Therapy (Splints, Exercises, etc.)

Purpose: Treatment for temporomandibular joint disorders to reduce pain, improve jaw function, and prevent further damage.

First 24 Hours:

- Follow appliance wear instructions exactly (daytime, nighttime, or both).
- Use ice packs externally for 15-minute intervals to reduce swelling if discomfort occurs.

Pain & Sensitivity:

- Mild soreness or tightness in jaw muscles may occur initially.
- Use OTC pain relievers as directed.

Oral Hygiene:

- Clean any appliances daily with a toothbrush and mild soap or appliance cleaner.
- Brush teeth and floss normally.

Diet:

- Eat soft foods during initial treatment to reduce strain on the jaw.
- Avoid chewing gum, hard foods, and very chewy foods.

Special Precautions:

- Avoid wide mouth opening (yawning excessively, biting large sandwiches).
- Perform any prescribed jaw exercises as instructed.

Follow-Up:

- Bring the appliance to every appointment for evaluation and adjustment.
- Contact the office if pain increases, jaw locking occurs, or the appliance is damaged.